



Visual Materials from the Lawrence E. Spivak Papers

including photographs from Meet the Press radio and television programs

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Prints & Photographs Division

Prints & Photographs Reading Room

101 Independence Ave, SE

James Madison Building, LM 337

Washington, DC 20540-4730

URL: <https://hdl.loc.gov/loc.pnp/pp.print>

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Summary Information

Repository: Prints & Photographs Division
Source: Spivak, Lawrence E. (Lawrence Edmund), 1900-1994, collector.
Title: Visual Materials from the Lawrence E. Spivak Papers
ID: pp020019
ID [aspace_uri]: https://hdl.loc.gov/loc.pnp/eadpnp.pp020019
Date [inclusive]: 1940-1980
Date [bulk]: Majority of material found within (1950-1975)
Physical Description: 5,750 items (ca)
Abstract: Collection consists primarily of photographs related to Lawrence Spivak's long career in radio and television journalism. The bulk of the images are routine portrait photos and group shots of national and international political figures who were guests on the public affairs panel series *Meet the Press*. Also included are numerous autographed portrait photos of *Meet the Press* guests as well as images from Spivak's two other TV series, *Keep Posted* and *The Big Issue*. Further materials include miscellaneous photos relating to Spivak's career. Also, original and reproduction cartoon drawings relating to *Meet the Press* and to the magazine *American Mercury* (early 1940s).
Language of Materials: Collection material in English

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Preferred Citation: Researchers wishing to cite this collection should include the following information:
 Library of Congress, Prints & Photographs Division, [reproduction number, e.g.,
 LC-USZ62-123456]

Biographical Note

Lawrence Edmund Spivak was born in 1900 in New York City. He graduated cum laude from Harvard University in 1921 and began his career in publishing as business manager of *Antiques* magazine. In 1934, he became business manager of *American Mercury* magazine; he later became its publisher and editor. In Washington, D.C., in 1945, with radio producer Martha Rountree, Spivak co-founded and co-produced the weekly public affairs program *Meet the Press*, first on radio, and then in 1947 added a separate television edition on the NBC network. Separate shows were produced until 1950, when the radio edition ceased. In 1953, Spivak bought Martha Rountree's interest in the program. The National Broadcasting Company purchased *Meet the Press* in 1955, and Spivak remained as regular panelist, producer, and moderator of the program until he retired in 1975. He was a consultant to NBC after 1975. Spivak died on March 9, 1994.

For a more extensive biography see the Manuscript Division's [finding aid](#) for the Lawrence E. Spivak papers, 1917-1994.

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Scope and Content Note

The collection consists primarily of photographs related to Lawrence Spivak's long career in radio and television journalism. The bulk of the images are routine portrait photos and group shots of national and international political figures who were guests on the public affairs panel series *Meet the Press*. Also included are numerous autographed portrait photographs of *Meet the Press* guests as well as images from Spivak's two other TV series, *Keep Posted* and *The Big Issue*. Further materials include miscellaneous photos relating to Spivak's career as well as original and reproduction cartoon drawings relating to *Meet the Press* and to the magazine *American Mercury* (early 1940s).

The material spans the years 1945-1980; the bulk falls into the period 1950-1975. The photographic materials include 5,072 photographic prints (most are 8" x 10" black-and-white silver gelatin prints), 637 contact sheets (7,839 images), and a number of negatives. There are also cartoons: 31 drawings and 14 photomechanical prints.

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Arrangement

The collection is organized in several cohesive sections. The bulk of the collection is grouped in LOTs according to subject matter or physical characteristics. The *Meet the Press* photographs are in three LOTs arranged chronologically by broadcast date with a separate folder for each program. The finding aid covers all three LOTs giving access by broadcast date and by the name of each guest. For *Keep Posted* there is also a checklist of programs and for LOT 13025 (F) there is an alphabetical index of guests who appeared on *Meet the Press*.

- [LOT 11683 \(H\)](#): Autographed portraits of associates, by Hank Walker
- [LOT 11684 \(H\)](#): Reproductions of cartoons and ads for *Meet the Press*
- [LOT 13025 \(F\)](#): *Meet the Press* radio and television programs
- [LOT 13026 \(F\)](#): Autographed photos from *Meet the Press*
- [LOT 13027 \(F\)](#): *Keep Posted* television program
- [LOT 13028 \(F\)](#): *The Big Issue* television program and specials
- [LOT 13029 \(F\)](#): Miscellaneous photos of Spivak
- [LOT 13031 \(H\)](#): Large photos from *Meet the Press*
- [LOT 13032 \(H\)](#): Autographed portraits of associates

Corresponding [negatives](#) are noted on the back of prints when those negatives have been processed in series LC-S64.

The [Cartoon Drawings](#) are filed with the division's individually indexed drawings in the CD 1 series.

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Administrative Information

Publication Statement

Prints & Photographs Division

URL: <https://hdl.loc.gov/loc.pnp/pp.print>

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Provenance

Lawrence E. Spivak donated all of the materials to the Library of Congress. Some of the pictorial materials came to the Prints and Photographs Division from the Manuscript Division; some, Spivak gave directly to Prints and Photographs. The donations were intermittent, 1970 to 1985.

Transfer; LC Manuscript Division (Papers of Lawrence E. Spivak), 1979 and 1992 (DLC/PP-1979:165 and DLC/PP-1992:228).

Gift from Lawrence E. Spivak, 1972, 1980, 1985 (DLC/PP-1972:184, DLC/PP-1980:012, DLC/PP-1985:611).

Processing History

The collection finding aid was compiled by Arden Alexander, Vickie Crawley, and Sarah Rouse in 1993. This finding aid contains unverified data from old container lists for LOT 13027, LOT 13028 and LOT 13029, which were transcribed by Erin Ebert in 2020. Finding aid encoded by Kristen Sosinski in January 2021.

Not all of the groups of material are described at the same level of detail. Additional materials that form the Visual materials from the Lawrence E. Spivak papers not included in this finding aid are listed below. For more information about service of these additional materials, search our [Online Catalog](#) by call number.

- Visual materials from the papers of Lawrence E. Spivak [unprocessed portion]
 - PR 13 CN 1979:165
 - PR 13 CN 1979:231
 - PR 13 CN 1980:012
 - PR 13 CN 1991:293
 - PR 13 CN 1995:004
 - PR 13 CN 1995:090

Transfers

Some materials were transferred from the Manuscript Division to the Prints and Photographs Division. A portion of the collection including broadcast transcripts, correspondence, and other manuscript materials is still located in the Manuscript Division and can be identified as part of the Lawrence E. Spivak papers, 1917-1994. An inventory of this material is available in their [finding aid](#). More information about the division can be found at the Manuscript Division [Homepage](#) and [Contact Page](#).

Some sound recordings and videotapes have been transferred to the Motion Picture, Broadcasting, and Recorded Sound Division and can be identified as part of the Meet the Press Collection. All *Meet the Press* shows received in the Motion Picture, Broadcasting and Recorded Sound Division from the following sources are in the Meet the Press Collection: Spivak (Lawrence E.), NBC/Spivak (Lawrence E.) and NBC. More information about the division's research centers can be found at the MBRS, Moving Image Section [Homepage](#) and [Contact Page](#) as well as the MBRS, Recorded Sound Section [Homepage](#) and [Contact Page](#).

Rights Restrictions

Publication may be restricted. For full information see ["Rights and Restrictions Information"](#) for the Visual Materials from the Lawrence E. Spivak Papers.

Access Restrictions

The collection is open to research.

Requesting Materials

For information about service in the Prints and Photographs Reading Room, including obtaining copies, see ["Using the Reading Room."](#)

Online Content

To see already digitized images from this collection, search our [Online Catalog](#) by call number or descriptive words.

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Related Material

Other Library of Congress Resources:

- Broadcasts of the *Meet the Press* shows received through copyright deposit are part of the Copyright Collection (Library of Congress) in the Motion Picture, Broadcasting and Recorded Sound Division
- *Meet the Press* materials are also included in the NBC Radio Collections and NBC Television Collections in the Motion Picture, Broadcasting and Recorded Sound Division. For more information, refer to the National Broadcasting Company at the Library of Congress [research guide](#).

Controlled Access Headings

- Drawings--1940-1980.
- Gelatin silver prints--1940-1980.
- Group portraits--1940-1980.
- Journalism--1940-1980.
- Journalists--1940-1980.
- Lawrence E. Spivak collection [graphic]
- Meet the Press collection [graphic]
- Meet the press (Radio program)
- Meet the press (Television program)
- Portrait photographs--1940-1980.
- Television programs--1940-1980.
- Rountree, Martha.
- Spivak, Lawrence E. (Lawrence Edmund), 1900-1994.
- Spivak, Lawrence E. (Lawrence Edmund), 1900-1994. , donor.
- Meet the Press Collection (Library of Congress)
- National Broadcasting Company--People--1940-1980.

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Alphabetical Index for LOT 13025 (F)

Download the [Alphabetical Index for LOT 13025 \(F\)](#) for a listing of the various guests of *Meet the Press* correlated with their locations in the collection. Guests include national and international figures such as heads of state, presidential candidates, members of Congress, mayors, governors, cabinet officers, civil rights leaders, labor leaders, economists, ambassadors, physicians, and occasionally a cultural or sports figure.

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Bibliography

- Library of Congress., Melville, A. (1980). [Special collections in the Library of Congress: a selective guide.](#) Washington: The Library.

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Collection Inventory

Container Contents

Autographed portraits of associates of Lawrence Spivak, April 19, 1954

Scope and Contents

Portraits of five U.S. senators by Life magazine photographer Hank Walker. Sitters include Senators Eugene Millikin, Clyde Hoey, Leverett Saltonstall, Styles Bridges, and Alexander Wiley. Mats are autographed with the names of the sitters and a message to Spivak.

Identifier Call Number: LOT 11683 (H)

Physical Description Extent:: 5 photographic prints (in mats) : b&w ; 13 x 10 in. or smaller.

Reproductions of cartoons and advertisements relating to Meet the Press, ca. 1956-1968

Scope and Contents

Reproductions of "L'il Abner" cartoon strips by Al Capp and other cartoons and comic strips depicting *Meet the Press* or Lawrence Spivak, which appeared in various newspapers and magazines. Also includes one advertisement for a 1956 appearance of *Meet the Press* producer Lawrence Spivak at the "Mammoth Grotto Show" in Narragansett Park.

Identifier Call Number: LOT 11684 (H)

Physical Description Extent:: 14 photomechanical prints (on mounts) ; 30 x 20 in.

Photographs from Meet the Press radio and television programs, 1945-1980, bulk: (bulk 1945-1975, bulk: 1979-1980)

Scope and Contents

Images from 1,462 *Meet the Press* shows are included in this collection. The majority of the photographs depict guests, panels of journalists, producers Lawrence Spivak and Martha Rountree, and moderators Rountree, Spivak, Ned Brooks, and others posed on the set of the *Meet the Press* show. Some images show production equipment, backstage scenes, and views of the audience. Also includes some publicity photographs of guests. Included are national and international figures such as heads of state, presidential candidates, members of Congress, mayors, governors, cabinet officers, civil rights leaders, labor leaders, economists, ambassadors, and physicians. Occasionally a cultural or sports figure appears such as Carl Sandburg, Robert Frost, Edward Steichen, and Jackie Robinson. Guests who appeared on the program 10 or more times include: J. William Fulbright, Walter W. Heller, Hubert H. Humphrey, Henry M. Jackson, William F. Knowland, John V. Lindsay, Henry Cabot Lodge, Mike Mansfield, Edmund S. Muskie, Nelson A. Rockefeller, Sargent Shriver, Stuart Symington, Robert A. Taft, and George C. Wallace. Topics discussed on *Meet the Press* included international relations, domestic policy, congressional legislation, civil rights, political elections, the Vietnam War, McCarthyism, health care, the Watergate Affair, and the Cold War.

Identifier Call Number: LOT 13025 (F)

Arrangement Arranged into two series: Radio and Television, and then arranged chronologically by *Meet the Press* show date.

Physical Description Extent:: 4,560 photographic prints : b&w and some color ; 8 x 10 in. or smaller.

Physical Description Extent:: 617 contact sheets (7,134 images) : b&w ; 9 x 12 in. or smaller.

Radio programs, 1945-1950

October 5, 1945

Identifier Call Number: LOT 13025-1 (F)

Guest: Johnston, Eric

Physical Description Extent:: 2 items

Box 1